

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

compare–prose

Two prose options side-by-side with a labeled corner tag on each.

Two options, equal footing, corner tags.

THE LEFT OPTION

Each pane holds one option's case in up to twenty words of prose, tagged at the corner.



THE RIGHT OPTION

The panes stay symmetric; a longer case belongs in the vertical variant, not a taller card.

transition reads left as before, right as after.

BEFORE

The arrow between the panes turns comparison into change over time.



AFTER

Use it for state changes, not preferences — the arrow implies causation.

mirror swaps the reading order.

FIRST OPTION

Same anatomy, flipped; the corner tags travel with their panes.



SECOND OPTION

mirror renders this pane first — for when the deck's rhythm lands on the left.

chosen crowns the right pane the winner.

THE ROAD NOT TAKEN

The losing option keeps its full case — an honest comparison shows real strength.



THE VERDICT

The accent treatment marks this pane as the pick; pair with a reason, not a repeat.

decision stamps the verdict banner across the pair.

OPTION ONE

Both panes stay equal; the banner above carries the call.



DECISION

OPTION TWO

Use when the decision is made and the slide is the record.

vertical stacks the panes for longer cases.

THE TOP OPTION

Stacking buys full slide width, so a case may run toward its ceiling without the columns pinching.



THE BOTTOM OPTION

The trade is simultaneity — the eye compares in sequence, so lead with the keeper.

banner-tag fills the corner tags at banner weight.

OPTION A

The tag takes the accent fill and full contrast.



OPTION B

Use for short, loud labels — verdicts, camps, teams.

rejected strikes the losing pane.

THE PICK

The surviving option reads at full strength.



THE REJECTED PANE

Dimmed and struck — the record of what was considered and declined.

The second axis: how far it reaches.

The verb is one axis — how you think. **Reach** is the other — how far what you make travels.

I

Own the verb

You can do the cognitive work —
correct, clear, complete. It
reaches only you.



II

Widen the reach

The work travels: team, org, field.
Documented, adopted, durable.

✦ *Most engineers stall on making it travel, not on the thinking.*

Two full cases is the most this pair holds.

THE STRESSED TOP PANE

A case at the hard budget runs about this long: two full sentences that state the option, its strongest argument, and the cost it accepts — and then stops.



THE STRESSED BOTTOM PANE

Symmetry matters most at the ceiling; when one pane runs half the other's length, the slide reads as a verdict the author did not intend to give.

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When NOT to reach for compare-prose.

Code comparison

Use `compare-code` for two fenced blocks. `compare-prose` is for sentences, not snippets.

Three or more options

`compare-prose` is strictly two. For three or more, use `cards-grid three` or `verdict-grid` with criteria badges.

Verbatim text differences

When the diff lives inside the prose itself — legal language, contract clauses — use `redline` so insertions and deletions render inline.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`compare-code` — the columns are code, not prose

`split-compare` — the verdict needs a bottom recommendation
bar

`verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared
criteria

`decision` — the verdict slide that lands after a comparison